



Escape from the Aliens in Outer Space: Ultimate Edition

Core Rules and Mechanics

Setup and Secret Roles

At the start, players are secretly divided into two teams: **Humans** (blue character cards) and **Aliens** (red character cards) ¹ ². There must be an equal number of Human and Alien roles (with Aliens outnumbering Humans by one if the player count is odd) ³. Each player receives a secret character card determining their identity and (in Ultimate Edition) a unique ability. Humans win by reaching an **Escape Pod** to evacuate, while Aliens win by hunting down and killing all Humans ⁴ ⁵. Identities are hidden, so players must deduce who is friend or foe by observing behavior and movements ⁶.

- **Humans:** Work alone to escape. They move **1 sector per turn**, but can utilize item cards to survive and misdirect the aliens ⁷.
- **Aliens:** Work together (covertly) to eliminate Humans. They move **1 or 2 sectors per turn** (and up to 3 once they've killed a Human; see *Alien Feeding* below) ⁷ ⁸. Aliens **cannot use items** (unless a special ability allows it) but have superior mobility ⁹.

All players get an **individual map booklet** (dry-erase) showing the ship's layout for a chosen "Zone" (map). Players record their moves secretly on their map each turn, writing the coordinates of the sector they move into ¹⁰ ¹¹. A game lasts at most **40 turns** (spaces on the movement log); it ends sooner if all humans have either escaped or been killed ¹².

Map Zones and Sector Types

The Ultimate Edition comes with **8 different map zones** (all from previous editions plus new ones) ¹³. Each map is a *sector grid* representing a different area of the ship "SELVA," with its own layout and strategic quirks ¹⁴. Sectors are identified by coordinate (letter+number) except special start sectors which have symbols ¹⁵. There are two types of sectors on a map: - **Silent (Safe) Sectors:** These are safe spots where moving there does not inherently cause noise. (Some maps even have none of these – e.g. *Zone Marconi* has **no Silent sectors**, forcing constant noise and backtracking ¹⁶.) If a player ends their move in a silent sector, they typically announce "**silence in all sectors**" to indicate no noise was made ¹⁷. - **Dangerous Sectors:** These are risky areas that might cause noise. When a player ends their move in a dangerous sector, they must draw a **Dangerous Sector card** and possibly announce noise (see Turn Sequence below) ¹⁷. Entering a dangerous sector means the player "knocked over something" or triggered a sound – everyone knows **some** noise came from that area ¹⁸.

Every map also designates special starting and objective sectors: - **Human Sector:** All Humans begin the game in this starting sector (marked on the map). After the game begins, no one can move through or end a turn in the Human sector again ¹⁹. - **Alien Sector:** All Aliens begin at this sector. Likewise, it cannot be re-

entered once the game starts ¹⁹ . (*Ultimate Edition note: One human character, the *Psychologist*, actually starts in the Alien sector as a twist ²⁰ .*) - **Escape Pod Sectors:** These are the critical exit points for Humans. Only Human players may move into an Escape Pod sector (Aliens are not allowed to enter them) ²¹ . Reaching a pod lets a human draw an Escape Pod card to see if they escape (see **Escape Pods** section).

Available Map Zones (Ultimate Edition)

Eight map layouts (zones) are included, each suited to different player counts and tactics:

Zone Name	Recommended Players	Map Characteristics
Galilei (Research)	4–8 players	Balanced, beginner-friendly map (equal mix of silent and dangerous sectors) ²² .
Fermi (Technological)	2–6 players	Strategically demanding; not recommended for novice humans (complex layout with many dangerous sectors) ²³ .
Galvani (Transport)	2–8 players	Favorable for experienced players; early movements have long-term consequences on this map ²⁴ .
Volta (Cargo)	4–8 players	Symmetrical design with a high density of dangerous sectors, rewarding quick thinking ²⁵ .
Marconi (Recreation)	6–8 players	Longer games; <i>no silent sectors</i> at all, so every move risks noise. Encourages double-back movement to confuse pursuers ²⁶ .
Socrates (Navigation)	2–6 players	Perfect symmetry; forces mind games and prediction of double-bluffs in movement ²⁷ .
Morgenland (Medical)	4–6 players	Narrow corridor design; ideal for ambush tactics and requires patient, creative play to outmaneuver opponents ²⁸ .
Levi-Montalcini (Labyrinth)	4–8 players	“Labyrinth” layout for advanced play; very competitive zone to truly test hunting vs. sneaking skills in a complex maze ²⁹ .

(*The Ultimate Edition includes all maps from the original Standard and Limited editions, plus new ones. Notably, Levi-Montalcini is a new exclusive map by the original authors ³⁰ .*)

Turn Sequence and Movement

Each turn, play proceeds with players taking turns in clockwise order (the first player is chosen randomly at start) ³¹. A turn consists of: **1) Movement, 2) Drawing a card (if required), and 3) Optional attack (if Alien).**

- **Movement:** On your turn, you **must move** to an adjacent sector (one hex step in any direction) and record it on your map log ³². Humans can move **1 sector** per turn. Aliens can move **1 or 2 sectors** per turn (they may choose to move only one) ⁷. (*Exception:* A special Alien power or the feeding bonus can allow moving 3 sectors in some cases – see *Character Abilities* and *Alien Feeding*.) Players cannot remain still, except one human (Executive Officer) who has a one-time ability to skip movement secretly ³³. After moving, if you ended in a **Dangerous sector**, you must draw a card from the Dangerous Sector deck; if in a Silent sector, you do not draw a card ³⁴ ³⁵.
- **Noise Cards & Announcements:** The drawn Dangerous Sector card (if any) determines what you *announce* to the table:
 - **Silence (white card):** Announce “*Silence in all sectors.*” No information about your position is revealed ³⁵.
 - **Noise in Your Sector (red card):** You must announce **your exact current sector coordinates** (e.g. “Noise in sector D08”) ³⁶. This effectively reveals where you are right now ³⁶.
 - **Noise in Any Sector (green card):** You must announce noise in **any sector of your choice** ³⁷. This lets you bluff – you *could* name your actual location or lie to throw others off ³⁷.
 - **Item (white card with item icon):** Treat as silence initially – announce “*Silence in all sectors.*” Keep the item card secret in front of you for later use ³⁸.

Importantly, **no one else sees the card you drew** ³⁹. Only the announced statement is public. This ambiguity is the heart of the game's bluffing: if someone says a coordinate, you don't know if they *had* to (red card) or chose to (green card), nor whether that player is an alien or human ⁴⁰. For example, announcing “Noise in sector B10” when you're actually in B9 leaves others unsure if you were forced to reveal (truthfully in B10) or if you lied to mislead them ⁴⁰.

- **Logging Clues:** All players can (and should) mark notes on their own map about what noises were announced and where. Tracking these clues helps deduce likely positions of others over time ⁴¹.
- **Staying Silent:** If you did not draw a card (because you moved into a silent sector), you would simply announce “silence” (no noise) for your turn ¹⁷. Thus, every turn each player either calls out a noise somewhere or announces silence. Notably, other players can infer that if you only said “silence,” you likely ended your move in a silent sector (since drawing a Silence card or Item also results in a silence announcement, this alone isn't definitive proof of your sector, but it narrows possibilities).

Items and Equipment

The Ultimate Edition introduces **Item cards** that Humans can use to gain special actions or one-time abilities ⁴² ⁴³. Only Humans may *use* items under normal rules ⁴⁴ – Aliens cannot use them unless their

character ability specifically allows a certain item type ⁴⁴ ⁴⁵ . However, Aliens can still **pick up** item cards (keeping them face-down) to feign being human and confuse others ⁴⁴ .

- **Drawing Items:** Item cards are mixed into the Dangerous Sector deck (they count as “silence” when drawn). If you draw one, keep it hidden instead of discarding, and later you may play it on your turn ³⁹ ³⁸ . You can even use an item in the same turn you obtained it, or save it for later ⁴⁶ . You may hold multiple items and even identical ones; used items are revealed and kept face-up (out of play) thereafter ⁴⁷ .
- **Using Items:** You can play items **at the start or end of your movement** (timing varies by item; some say “play at beginning of turn”) ⁴⁶ . When used, reveal the card and follow its effect ⁴⁸ . Each item is single-use and then discarded from the game ⁴⁸ . Using an item does **not** count as your movement; many items grant bonus moves or other actions in addition to your normal move ⁴⁹ ⁵⁰ .

Below is a summary of all item types in Ultimate Edition and their effects:

- **Attack:** Allows a Human to perform an **attack** at end of their turn (same as Alien attack rules) ⁵¹ .
Note: The human still only moves 1 sector before attacking ⁵¹ . This card essentially lets a Human try to kill a nearby player (potentially taking out an alien) – very powerful but using it will likely reveal the user is Human (since normally only Aliens attack) ⁵² .
- **Teleport:** Instantly move **directly to the Human Sector** (start area) from anywhere ⁴⁹ . You can use this either **before or after** your normal move in the turn ⁴⁹ . (Effectively, you could move one step, then teleport to start, or teleport first then take your step elsewhere.) This can be a great escape or mind-game tool, letting a human “reset” their position far across the map.
- **Adrenaline:** Grants an **extra move** – you may move 1 additional sector *this turn* ⁵⁰ . Play at the **start** of your turn to move up to 2 sectors instead of 1. (Important: even with two moves, you only draw a noise card **once**, based on your final landing sector ⁵⁰ .)
- **Sedatives:** Allows a completely silent move. Play at the **start** of your turn; this turn you **do not draw a Dangerous Sector card at all**, even if you land in a dangerous sector ⁵³ . Essentially, you ensure no noise is made on this turn.
- **Defense:** A personal shield against attacks. Play this **immediately if an Alien attacks you** (targeting your sector) ⁵⁴ . You **ignore the attack** and survive ⁵⁴ . (The alien’s attack has no effect – they essentially wasted their attack.)
- **Spotlight:** A scouting tool. When played, **name any sector** on the map. Every player currently in that sector *or* any of the six adjacent sectors must immediately announce their exact coordinates ⁵⁵ . (They do *not* have to say who they are, just their location.) This affects **all players (Humans and Aliens)** in the area ⁵⁵ – including potentially the user if you are in that vicinity. It’s a way to flush out anyone hiding in a specific zone.
- **Sensor:** A direct scanner. Target **one player**; that player must immediately announce their exact current coordinates ⁵⁶ . (Again, works on either team.) This reveals one person’s position with certainty ⁵⁶ . It’s great if you have a suspicion about where a specific opponent is.
- **Clone:** A “second life” for humans. Play this immediately when an Alien attacks and would kill you ⁵⁷ . You **do not turn into an alien**; instead, your *clone* activates – your character “dies,” but next turn you re-enter the game at the Human Sector as a human (your identity is revealed at that moment) ⁵⁷ . Essentially, the aliens killed your clone, while the real you gets a last-chance restart (you discard any items you were carrying when you died) ⁵⁷ .

- **Mutation:** A bizarre card that **turns a Human into an Alien** ⁵⁸. If a human player uses this, they immediately switch teams: their character mutates and they continue playing as an alien from that same location ⁵⁸. Their goal changes to killing the remaining humans. (This is typically an optional twist; a desperate human might do this if escape seems impossible, effectively “joining the winning side.”)
- **Cat:** A decoy device for noise. Play *before* you draw a sector card on your turn ⁵⁹. It allows you to declare **noise in two different sectors** that turn ⁵⁹. If you end up drawing a “Noise in Your Sector” card, one of those two noises **must** be your real sector; if you drew any other card (Noise-any, Silence, or Item), then you can choose *any* two sectors to make noise in (they can both be bluffs) ⁶⁰. After using Cat, if you drew a Silence or Item card, you must discard it (you don’t get to keep the item, as you’ve effectively used it to create false noise) ⁶⁰. **Example:** A human suspecting an alien is nearby uses a Cat to create noise in two faraway sectors, misleading the alien on their trail ⁶¹ ⁶².

(Ultimate Edition includes two new item types – Cat and Mutation – and also retains two special items (Sensor and Clone) that were once limited-edition exclusives ⁴³. All item effects are summarized on the player’s map book for easy reference.)

Attacking and Combat

Combat is straightforward: **only Aliens can normally attack**. On an Alien player’s turn, after moving, they have the option to **forgo drawing a card and declare an attack** instead ⁶³ ⁶⁴. Humans cannot attack unless they use an Attack item or have a special ability (e.g. the Soldier) ⁵².

- **Alien Attack Procedure:** The alien must have moved into the sector they want to attack. They then announce “**I attack in sector [X]!**” using the coordinates of the sector they ended their move in ⁶³. When an attack is declared:
 - Any player currently in that sector **must declare their presence** immediately ⁶⁵.
 - Whoever is in that sector is **killed** outright, whether Human or Alien ⁶⁵.
 - The killed player reveals their identity (character card) and is out of that role ⁶⁶. If a Human was killed, that player will **re-enter next turn as a new Alien** (see Conversion below) ⁶⁷. If an Alien was killed, they are **eliminated from the game** permanently ⁶⁸.
- The attacking alien **does not draw a sector card** this turn (the attack replaces the noise draw) ⁶³. Their turn ends after the attack.
- **Combat Outcomes & Conversion:** When a **Human is killed** by an alien, the human player is not out of the game – on their next turn, they “**respawn**” **from the Alien sector as a new Alien** ⁶⁹ ⁶⁷. (They lose any items and special abilities they had; they effectively become a generic alien minion) ⁷⁰. The Human’s original character card is revealed and discarded, so everyone learns who they were. That player now works with the Alien team for the rest of the game. When an **Alien is killed** (e.g. shot by a Soldier or accidentally attacked by a fellow alien), that player is completely eliminated – they do not come back ⁶⁸. This risk of **alien-on-alien friendly fire** is a crucial deterrent against aliens attacking recklessly at every opportunity ⁵² ⁷¹. In other words, if an alien guesses wrong and attacks a sector containing another alien, their teammate dies and the alien side is permanently down a member ⁷². This threat forces aliens to use deduction and caution rather than brute-forcing every adjacent space.

- **Alien Feeding (Speed Boost):** As a reward for a successful hunt, if an Alien manages to kill at least one human during the game, that Alien mutates to become faster ⁸. For the rest of the game, that particular alien can move up to **3 sectors per turn** (instead of the normal 1–2) ⁸. This bonus does **not** stack – killing more humans doesn’t increase beyond 3 – but it makes veteran alien hunters extremely dangerous in endgame. (*Converted humans who become aliens do not inherit any speed boost the killer had; only the killer gains the boost*) ⁷³. All aliens still need to be careful: a speedy alien can cover ground quickly, but if they attack indiscriminately, they might hit a fellow alien, as noted above.

Example: Alien player Paolo hears a suspicious noise and moves into sector D08, suspecting a human is there. Instead of drawing a card, he declares “I attack in D08.” If any player was in D08, they’d announce themselves and be killed. In our scenario, suppose Human Claudio was indeed there – Claudio is slain and his Human identity is revealed ⁷⁴ ⁶⁹. Claudio will now rejoin the game next turn from the Alien start sector, now on the alien team. Paolo, having killed a human, gets the movement speed boost (up to 3 sectors per turn) on his subsequent turns ⁷⁴ ⁸. If, however, no one was in D08 (a missed attack), nothing happens – except that Paolo has now given away that he is an alien (only aliens can attack) and exactly where he is. This kind of clue can turn the tables if used at the wrong time.

Escape Pods and Endgame

Scattered at the far reaches of each map are the **Escape Pod sectors** – these are the Humans’ objective. Each Escape Pod sector is labeled (often by a number, e.g. Pod 1, Pod 2, etc.). **Only Humans may enter an Escape Pod sector**; aliens cannot step into or attack those sectors ²¹. Reaching a pod is not a guaranteed escape – it must be a working pod. Here’s how it works:

- **Attempting Escape:** When a human moves into an Escape Pod sector, they immediately announce **which pod number** they’ve reached (so everyone knows, e.g. “I have reached Escape Pod 3”) ⁷⁵. Then the player draws an **Escape Pod card** from the pod deck and reveals it ⁷⁵. There are two possible outcomes:
- **Green Card (“Working Pod”):** The pod is functional – the Human **successfully escapes** the ship ⁷⁶! They are removed from the game as a survivor. That escape pod is now **launched and gone**; no other player can use that same pod anymore ⁷⁷ ⁷⁸. (Mark that pod as unavailable.)
- **Red Card (“Damaged Pod”):** The pod is a failure – it’s damaged or locked and cannot be used ⁷⁹. The Human **does not escape** and remains in that sector. Moreover, that escape pod is now permanently **disabled** – for the rest of the game, no one can use or even enter that pod’s sector ⁷⁹. The stranded Human must try to reach a *different* pod if any remain. The rules specify that a human in a failed pod sector **cannot be attacked while in that sector** ⁷⁹, giving them a brief safe haven. But since that pod is useless, they’ll have to leave and find another, at which point they are fair game again.
- **Engineer’s Advantage:** The Human character *Engineer* has a special ability when reaching a pod: he draws **two** Escape Pod cards and looks at both, choosing which result to use (the other is shuffled back) ⁸⁰. This effectively doubles his chances of finding a green (working) pod.
- **Game End and Winning:** The game ends immediately when **the last human is either dead (killed) or has escaped** ¹², or when the 40th turn concludes. Humans who successfully escaped are

counted as winners. Aliens win if all humans on the ship have been killed (converted) before they escape. Notably, it's possible for **both sides to "win"** in some sense: for example, if one human escapes and all remaining humans are killed, that escaped human **wins**, and the aliens also achieve their objective of eliminating the last human onboard ¹². Any human who gets killed (and thus fails to escape) **loses** individually ¹². If the turn limit runs out or all escape pods become inaccessible (used or destroyed) and some humans are still trapped, those humans are considered eliminated – the aliens effectively win in that scenario ⁸¹.

Strategic Advice for Human Players

Human players face the daunting task of sneaking to a distant escape pod without giving away their trail. The key themes for humans are **stealth, misdirection, and timing**. Below we break down strategy tips for Humans at different skill levels:

Beginner Strategies (Humans)

- **Stick to Silent Routes:** As a new human player, try to move through **silent sectors** whenever possible to minimize drawing noise cards. Making no noise (or announcing "silence") every turn helps keep your position ambiguous. For example, the *Galilei* map offers a balanced mix of silent sectors – a good choice for beginners to practice quiet movement ²².
- **Avoid Beelining Straight to a Pod:** A common novice mistake is heading in a direct line toward the nearest escape pod. This is predictable and "makes it fairly easy to get picked off by the aliens" ⁸². Instead, **slow down and double back** occasionally. Moving unpredictably (even away from your goal at times) can confuse aliens who are tracking your last known direction ⁸².
- **Use Noise Cards to Bluff:** When you do step into dangerous sectors and draw a noise card, use the opportunity wisely. If you get a **"Noise in Any Sector"** card, announce a sector that *isn't* where you are – ideally one that misleads the aliens away from your route. For instance, if you're in the west side of the map, you might call a noise on the east side. Don't be afraid to **bluff**; aliens have limited info and may chase phantoms if you bluff convincingly ⁴⁰.
- **Pay Attention to Others' Announcements:** Even as you hide, listen carefully to noises called out by all players. You might start picking up which players could be aliens (e.g. someone who *never* seems to make noise might be creeping exclusively in silent sectors – a possible alien tell). Keep simple notes on your map of where noises occurred each round; this will help you avoid danger zones.
- **Safety in Numbers? (Be Cautious):** It's generally not wise for humans to cluster together, because an alien attack could kill one of you and then the other next. However, as a beginner, you might feel safer moving in parallel with another player's suspected position (without actually meeting). If you strongly suspect another is human (e.g. they used an item only humans can use), you could *shadow* their noise pattern so you're not the sole target. Just remember, you can't truly cooperate or share info openly (that risks revealing yourselves to aliens), so "sticking together" is limited and can backfire.

Intermediate Strategies (Humans)

- **Misdirection and Double-Bluffing:** At this level, begin employing **double-bluffs**. For example, occasionally announce a false noise in a sector that *is* actually near your location – making aliens think "surely they wouldn't call the real spot," when in fact you did (mind games!). Mix up your

strategy: sometimes tell the truth on a green card, other times lie. The goal is to make aliens second-guess which of the noises could be genuine ⁸² .

- **Utilize Items Optimally:** By now you should be comfortable with item effects. **Timing is everything.** Use **Sedatives** on a turn you suspect an alien is closing in and you desperately need to move through a dangerous sector without making noise. Use **Adrenaline** when you need an unexpected burst – for instance, if you’re two steps from an escape pod and worry an alien is one step behind you, an Adrenaline can let you leap into the pod before they catch up ⁸³ . **Teleport** can be a brilliant mid-game play: if aliens think they’ve cornered you, teleport back to the Human sector and watch them scramble in confusion (though use this sparingly, as revealing your identity by teleporting can make you a known target) ⁸⁴ ⁸⁵ .
- **Leverage Character Abilities:** Intermediate players can start using their character’s one-time power for maximum impact. For example, the *Soldier* should use his single Attack wisely – perhaps if you deduce an adjacent player is an alien, surprise-attack them to even the odds ⁸⁶ ⁸⁷ . The *Pilot* or an item like **Cat** can create multiple noise signals to send the aliens on wild goose chases ⁸⁸ ⁸⁹ . If you’re the *Medic* and you have a strong hunch about another player’s identity, you might force a reveal – but be very careful, as using that power exposes you too ⁹⁰ . Generally, save your ability for a clutch moment: it can dramatically shift the game if used at the right time.
- **Observe Alien Behavior:** By this stage, you should pay attention not just to where noises occur, but **how frequently** and **what type** of noises certain players announce. Aliens often try to stay silent; if a player frequently announces “silence in all sectors” but you know they must be moving each turn, they might be sticking to silent sectors or drawing Silence cards – could be an alien strategy. On the other hand, a player who consistently draws noise cards and even uses items (which aliens typically can’t) is likely human. Use these patterns to your advantage and adjust your route. For example, avoid areas where you suspect multiple aliens are prowling, and perhaps head for a less expected escape pod if the “obvious” pod is likely guarded.
- **Coordinate Discreetly (if possible):** Humans can’t openly team up without revealing themselves to aliens, but subtle coordination can happen. For instance, if two humans figure each other out (maybe one saw the other use a human-only item), they might intentionally **stagger their noise** to confuse aliens. One human could start making decoy noises to draw alien attention while the other makes a quieter dash to a pod. This is risky and requires unspoken understanding, but clever players can sometimes pull it off.

Advanced Strategies (Humans)

- **Psychological Maneuvering:** At an advanced level, humans can engage in serious mind games. **Feign being an Alien** – this is a high-level bluff where you intentionally act *less* scared and more “predatory” to avoid drawing alien suspicion. For example, you might occasionally choose to move into a dangerous sector and *not* lie about your position (revealing yourself) early on, which an alien typically wouldn’t do so readily. If aliens think you’re one of them, they may leave you alone or even accidentally reveal themselves to you. This is hard to execute but can sow confusion in the alien team.
- **Dynamic Route Planning:** Advanced humans will plan their route to the pods dynamically based on evolving information. Always have a Plan B (or C). If Pod 2 turns out to be destroyed or heavily camped by aliens, pivot and start working your way covertly to another pod. You should be mapping probable alien locations each turn in your head or notes. Use that to carve out a path that maximizes silent moves and minimizes intersections with where aliens likely are. On complex maps like *Levi-Montalcini*, use the maze-like structure to your advantage: double-back into loops to lose pursuers and don’t be afraid to take a longer path if it stays in the shadows.

- **Item Combination and Deception:** Think several moves ahead with items. For instance, you might save a **Defense** and **Clone** combo as your endgame insurance: if you're one step from a pod but an alien is right on you, let them attack – your Defense card negates one attack, and even if a second alien hits you, Clone ensures you'll still get another chance from the start ⁵⁵ ⁵⁷ . Another advanced trick: if you have a **Mutation** card (rare for a human to consider), you could intentionally use it at a dramatic moment to flip to the alien side – not because you want the aliens to win, but maybe to deceive them and *stall*. (As a new alien, you might mislead the other aliens or abstain from helping effectively, buying time for any remaining humans. It's a bizarre gambit and not for the faint of heart!) Generally, only very confident players should attempt something like that.
- **Maximize Bluffing Value:** By now you'll recognize when aliens are desperate for clues. Use this against them. If you notice the aliens are unsure and scattering, a well-placed **Spotlight** or **Sensor** item can actually benefit humans too – for example, use a Spotlight not just to find aliens, but to make *aliens reveal each other*. If you catch two players in the spotlight and both report positions far apart, you might have just confirmed those two are likely aliens (humans rarely occupy adjacent sectors without knowing). Sharing that info with subtle table talk ("Hmm, interesting, two pings over there... maybe they should trust each other.") might tip off other humans without explicitly revealing you.
- **Endgame Sacrifice Plays:** In some endgame scenarios, an advanced human might sacrifice themselves to ensure at least one human escapes. Example: If there are two humans left and one alien, and you have reason to believe the alien will catch the other human, a Soldier human could deliberately attack and kill the other human (mistaking them as alien) – this would turn that human into an alien (now two aliens), and immediately end the game since the "last human" was killed, but *not before* perhaps the sacrificer already escaped. This is an extreme example and usually not optimal, but it illustrates thinking outside the box: use the conversion mechanics in unconventional ways. (A more practical example: A soldier might kill an alien and then intentionally draw attention to himself so the other human can escape while the remaining aliens focus on the revealed soldier.) Every move should be weighed for the *team's* survival chances at this point – even though humans technically win individually, helping another human escape instead of you can be satisfying if you know you forced a partial win.

Finally, advanced humans will exploit **map-specific tactics**. For instance, on *Morgenland* (narrow corridors), you might leave an obvious trail of noise down one corridor, then use a Teleport or backtrack through a previously used route to slip out via another path while aliens follow the first trail. On *Socrates* (symmetrical), try to create a mirror-image bluff: mimic the kind of noises an alien might make on the opposite side of the map from your true movements – advanced aliens on that map will be expecting double-bluffs ²⁷ , so you can sometimes *triple-bluff* (go back to honesty) to throw them off.

Strategic Advice for Alien Players

Playing an Alien is about **hunting cleverly and deceiving the humans** until you're ready to strike. Aliens have superior mobility and numbers, but they lack trust (even of each other at first) and can't afford mistakes like killing a fellow alien. Key strategies involve deduction, coordination by inference, and well-timed aggression. Here are tips by experience level:

Beginner Strategies (Aliens)

- **Move Efficiently, Cover Ground:** As a new alien, take advantage of your ability to move up to 2 sectors per turn. In early game, **spread out** and sweep the map to locate the humans. It might be tempting to lurk, but inactivity gives humans more time to reach pods. Each alien should head toward different sectors to maximize the chance of hearing or cornering a human. For instance, on an 8-player map like *Galilei*, three aliens might each patrol a different quadrant. This way, any noise a human makes, at least one alien will be relatively near to investigate.
- **Don't Reveal Yourself Too Soon:** Avoid attacking at the first sound of a noise. Remember, the moment you attack and kill (or even miss), you basically announce "I'm an Alien at location X!" to everyone ⁵². Early in the game, it's usually better to move stealthily and gather info. If you attack blindly and the target was actually another alien, you've done great harm to your team ⁹¹ ⁹². So hold off until you're reasonably sure your target is human. Early-game alien strategy often involves pretending to be human: for example, if you draw a "Noise in Any Sector" card, you might **bluff noise** on yourself or in a plausible spot to make others think you're just another human making noise, rather than an alien prowling quietly.
- **Track the Humans' Noise:** As a hunter, you should be mentally (or physically) marking every noise announcement on a map. Try to **deduce possible human positions** from these clues. If someone keeps announcing noise far from where you know you are (and maybe where other aliens claim noise), that's likely a human on the run. Likewise, identify patterns: a player who never draws a card (never makes noise except "silence") could be either very lucky or sitting in silent sectors – possibly an alien like you. Be cautious around them (they might be a teammate). Conversely, someone who *does* occasionally make noise (and especially if they claim items or do things aliens can't) is a prime target.
- **Basic Coordination by Implication:** You don't know who your fellow aliens are initially, but you all share the goal of finding humans. Early on, you can use subtle cues to avoid accidental team-kills. For example, if you hear a noise from a player and you suspect it might be from an alien rather than a human (maybe it was an odd bluff or a quick silence in a dense area), you might choose not to rush that sector. Instead, communicate indirectly: you could announce a noise (if you get a Noise-in-Any card) in *your* location to signal "I am here." Another alien hearing that might infer "the person in that area might be an alien, since they weirdly announced noise on themselves." These are not guaranteed signals, but over time aliens might figure each other out by elimination. (*As a beginner, focus on not stepping on each others' toes; more explicit teamwork comes with experience.*)
- **Use Two-Step Movement Wisely:** With 2 moves, you can sometimes walk into a sector to draw out a noise, then step back to a safer position. For instance, you might move 1 sector into a likely human path (a dangerous sector to intentionally draw a card) hoping to get a Noise card that lets you bluff or confuse humans, then use your second move to retreat to a silent sector. This way, even if you had to announce noise, you end your turn in a silent spot, making it harder for humans to pinpoint you on their turn.

Intermediate Strategies (Aliens)

- **Deduction and Isolation:** By mid-game, try to **identify specific humans**. Use logic: if there were 3 noises and you know you caused one and suspect another alien caused another, the third is probably a human. Coordinate tacitly with other aliens to **pinch** that human. For example, if you and another alien have a rough idea of where a human is (between you two), try a pincer movement – approach

from different sides to corner them. You might not be openly talking, but you can watch each other's noise and movement patterns. Intermediate aliens often develop an intuition for where comrades are, simply by elimination and map coverage.

- **Feign Human Behavior:** Continue to use deception but in more clever ways. For instance, deliberately draw an Item card (by moving into dangerous sectors) even though you can't use items – simply to *hold it*. Showing that you picked up an item (by later announcing silence when perhaps you should have drawn a noise) can fool humans into thinking you're one of them carrying an item ⁹³ ⁴⁴ . You can later drop it or never use it; its mere existence served its purpose. Also, if you draw a Silence card, sometimes pretend it was a Noise-in-Any: instead of "silence," call a fake noise somewhere that benefits you. This might throw humans off and also potentially signal to any alien listening, "I had a silence but I'm faking noise," which a human usually wouldn't do.
- **Target Item Users:** If someone uses an item publicly (e.g. a Spotlight or Sensor effect occurs), that's a huge clue – *only humans can play items* in general. Immediately focus your efforts on that player; they've effectively outed themselves. Intermediate aliens prioritize such targets. Also, beware of human special abilities that mimic items: if a player teleported (and revealed as Co-Pilot) or attacked (Soldier), you now *know* their identity ⁹⁴ ⁸⁴ . Coordinate with the other aliens (with minimal words, maybe just "I think X is human") to hunt these revealed humans relentlessly before they reach an escape pod.
- **Efficient Killing vs. Caution:** Finding the right moment to strike is key. When you're reasonably sure you share a sector with a human (or one is adjacent and likely to step in next turn), consider attacking. Use knowledge: for example, if you heard a noise in sector F08 last turn and you're now in F08, there's a decent chance that human might still be near. But *check for crossfire*: if another alien might also be in F08 (perhaps chasing the same human from another side), coordinate briefly ("I'm in F08, going to attack next turn") if table talk rules allow that kind of limited info. Intermediate aliens might develop non-verbal signals or brief code words to avoid friendly fire (though any talking can tip off humans too). It's a fine balance between communication and secrecy.
- **Use Your Alien Powers:** Ultimate Edition aliens each have a unique ability – use them! The *Silent Alien* can use **Sedatives** items – if you find one, use it to slip by undetected and no human will imagine an alien just moved silently through a dangerous area ⁹⁵ ⁹⁶ . The *Fast Alien* can move 3 sectors on his very first move ⁹⁷ ; you should exploit that at game start to cover ground or even reach a common human entry area quickly (perhaps scaring a human into a mistake). The *Invisible Alien* can ignore sensor/spotlight – this means if a human plays a Sensor on you, instead of giving away location you reveal you're an alien ⁹⁸ ⁹⁹ . While that does expose you as alien, it's better than giving your exact spot; plus, you could even *fake being caught by a sensor* by volunteering an incorrect location (though technically against the rules, a crafty group might allow feinting – be careful with that). Each power can be clutch: *Lurking Alien* can opt to not move and attack in place – use that if you strongly suspect a human will wander into your sector next turn; just lie in wait ¹⁰⁰ .
- **Herd the Prey:** Intermediate aliens often attempt to **herd humans** toward each other or into dead-ends. If you know a human is in a certain region (from noise), you can intentionally make your presence known in that region (perhaps by purposefully drawing a noise in a neighboring sector or even saying something at the table like "Hmm, I heard something in this area..." in a joking way). The human, hearing an alien close, might flee in the opposite direction – which could be exactly where another alien is quietly waiting. Work with the map's features: e.g. drive humans out of the silent central rooms into the outer dangerous corridors where they're easier to detect.

Advanced Strategies (Aliens)

- **Mind Games and False Trails:** At the advanced level, aliens can turn the tables in bluffing. Consider occasionally **pretending to be a panicky human** – e.g. make unwise noise or use an Attack card (if you're the rare alien who got one via ability, like Brute can't but others might mimic). While aliens normally can't use Attack items, an advanced alien might attempt a wild ploy: take a Noise-in-Any card and *announce the exact sector you're actually in*. Humans hearing this might think "only a forced red card would make someone do that, so that must be a human who had bad luck." Now the humans believe that position belongs to a human. They might even steer clear of you or reveal themselves trying to reach you for coordination. Meanwhile you lie in ambush. These kinds of meta-bluffs require excellent poker face and understanding of how your opponents think.
- **Identify Fellow Aliens ASAP:** By now, you should be proficient at reading the game state to figure out who your teammates are early. Perhaps you notice two players always calling silence in sectors that are all connected – likely they are both aliens moving in silent pockets. Once you're fairly sure someone is a teammate, you can risk subtle cooperation: e.g. deliberately *not* chasing a noise that this suspected alien seems to be closer to (trusting them to handle it). Or if you're both in range of the same noise, maybe one of you says "I'll go after that one" (in character, you might disguise it as table banter like "I'm headed to the engine room to check that out"). Advanced groups sometimes allow light roleplaying chatter which you can exploit to coordinate without explicitly saying "I am alien, you too." Just be very cautious not to tip off humans with these signals.
- **Timed Strikes and Coordination:** An advanced alien team will coordinate their attacks almost simultaneously to overwhelm the humans. If you have deduced the likely locations of multiple humans, it can be devastating for aliens to strike in quick succession. For instance, in one turn Alien A attacks a sector where a human is hiding. In the very next turn, Alien B uses their boosted speed to reach another escape pod area and attacks another human. By denying humans time to react or share info between those turns, you prevent them from warning each other or using items to escape. Essentially, create a rapid "one-two punch" to wrap up the hunt. This requires timing and possibly a pre-arranged signal (or just intuition between experienced players).
- **Control the Endgame:** In late game, aliens should **guard the escape zones**. If only one or two humans remain, identify which escape pods are still available and try to cover them. You don't have to sit directly on a pod (remember, you can't enter pod sectors), but loiter one or two sectors away and listen. Use your superior speed (especially if any alien earned the 3-sector boost) to patrol between multiple pods if possible. Also use process of elimination: if three pods are gone and two remain, you know where the human must eventually go. Advanced aliens might even intentionally trigger the endgame condition in their favor: for example, if one human has escaped and only one left on board, killing that last human *immediately* ends the game in a joint win ¹². Even if there were more escape cards or time left, don't toy with them – finish it decisively.
- **Sacrifice and Deception:** Just as humans have sacrifice plays, aliens can also sacrifice – though it's rare. One advanced move: if you are **certain** another player is an alien and both of you are near a human, one alien might intentionally draw the human's fire (say, by making an obvious noise or even revealing themselves) so that the human uses up a weapon or item on them, allowing the other alien to then attack the now item-less human. For example, an alien might knowingly step into a Soldier's sector to trigger the Soldier's one-time attack (thus the alien dies, unfortunately, but the soldier's power is spent). The second alien can then immediately attack that same sector or soon after to kill the Soldier-human while they are vulnerable. This level of sacrifice is extreme and only worthwhile if it secures the alien victory (and if the aliens are okay with not all of them "surviving" – in a team sense, aliens still win even if only one alien is left standing at game end).

- **Leverage Character Powers Cunningly:** Each alien's power used in combo with strategy can be decisive at advanced play. For instance, the *Brute Alien* knows he is immune to attacks ¹⁰¹. If you are Brute and you suspect a particular human (maybe the Soldier) is nearby with an Attack ready, you can actually bait them into attacking you – revealing you as Brute but wasting their attack, since you won't die ¹⁰¹. Once they blow their chance, you or an ally can then eliminate that now-disarmed human. The *Psychic Alien* is an interesting one: he **must announce a noise even when drawing Silence** ¹⁰². This can be turned to your advantage: you are constantly giving *false* information (because a Psychic Alien never truly stays quiet – he always pretends to make some noise). Humans may overthink your consistent noise-bluffs, allowing you to mask as one of them or just confuse their deduction grid entirely. If you are Psychic, coordinate with others to ensure your constant “noise anywhere” doesn't accidentally point at them. Perhaps use a pattern (like always call noises in sectors in a specific pattern) that your fellow aliens recognize as the Psychic's signature, so they ignore it while humans get thrown off.
- **High-Level Bluff Coordination:** Advanced aliens in some groups develop almost a language of bluffing. For example, if one alien wants to confirm another is an alien, they might intentionally use the wrong grammar or a specific phrase in their noise announcement (“Noise in sector **Zed-10**” instead of “Z10”, etc.), something subtle that they agreed on beforehand as an identifier. It's meta-gaming and depends on group rules (some might forbid such signals), but if allowed, it can be potent. Essentially, you're using deception not just against humans but as a communication channel between aliens. Humans might pick up on it if they are savvy, so be careful and perhaps only use it when critical (like late game, to coordinate a final combined attack on the last human).

In summary, advanced alien play is about **controlling information**. You want to limit what the humans know (stay hidden, appear as innocuous as possible) while extracting maximum info from their slips, and then strike with coordination and precision. Always remember: as an alien, you have the advantage of **numbers and power**, but the disadvantage of uncertainty (not knowing who's who) – once you overcome that by identifying allies and enemies, you should relentlessly press that advantage to prevent the humans from escaping.

Sources: Core rules and item/role details are from the official *Ultimate Edition* rulebook ³⁶ ⁵⁰. Strategic insights are drawn from community forums and play experiences, emphasizing bluffing, deduction, and deception as highlighted by veteran players ⁸² ⁴⁰.

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